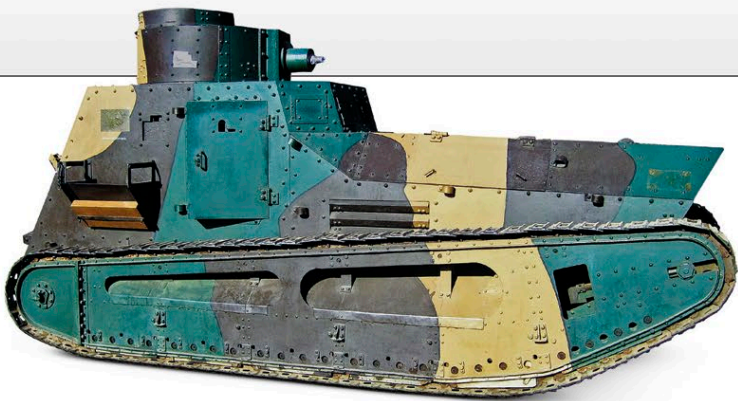


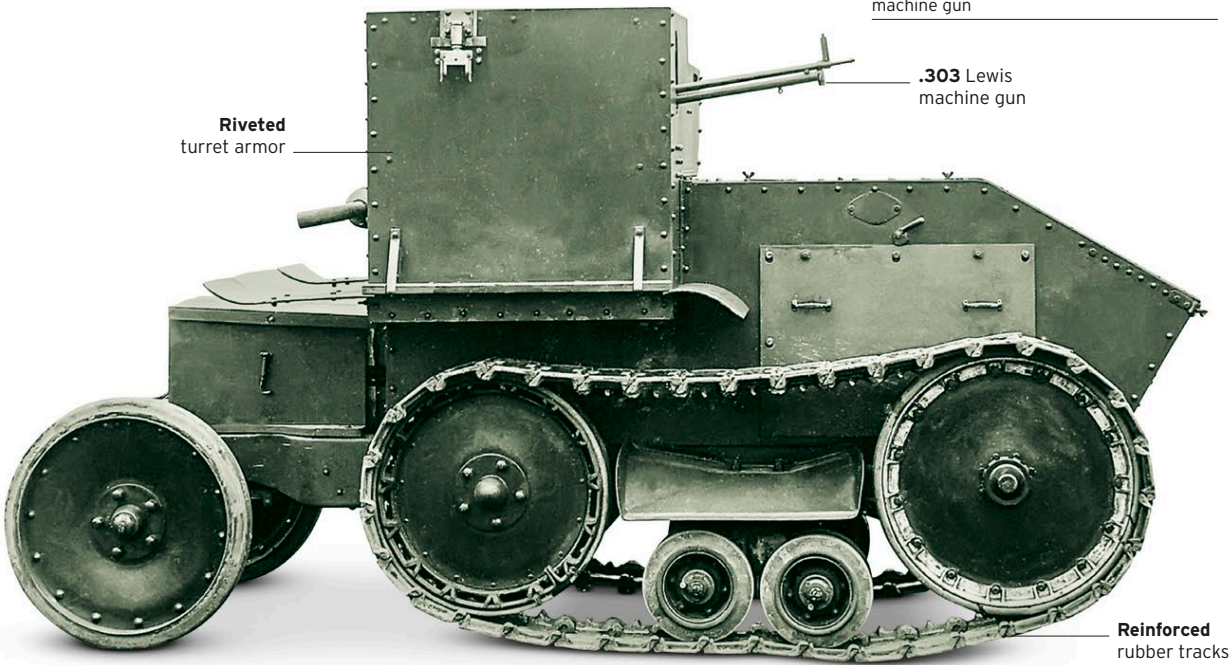
Interwar Experiments

As automotive technology improved during the 1920s and '30s, tanks became more reliable and capable. This progress, along with the debate over the future role of tanks on the battlefield, encouraged designers to be innovative. As a result, a wide range of experimental vehicles were developed. Some were designed to provide individual soldiers with armored protection, while others were intended as "land battleships" that could operate unsupported by other arms. Some proved to be harbingers of the future, while others were dead ends.



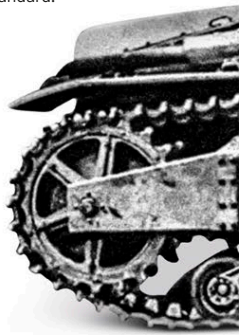
△ **Stridsvagn m/21**
Date 1921 **Country** Sweden
Weight 9.8 tons (8.9 tonnes)
Engine Daimler-Benz gasoline, 60 hp
Main armament 6.5 mm Ksp m/1914 machine gun

Sweden's very first tank, the four-man m/21 was based on the German LK II prototype. Due to the ban on tanks imposed on Germany by the Treaty of Versailles, the LK II was illegally and secretly exported to Sweden in pieces labeled as tractor parts. The m/21 was used for training purposes, and in the early 1930s five were upgraded to m/21-29 standard.



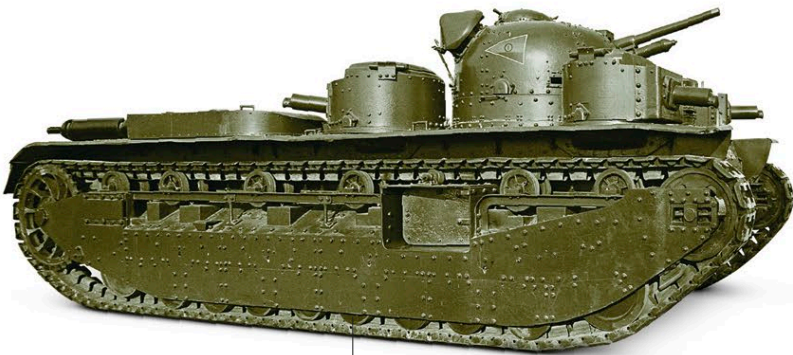
◁ **Morris-Martel Tankette**
Date 1926 **Country** UK
Weight 2.5 tons (2.2 tonnes)
Engine Morris 4 cylinder gasoline 16 hp
Main armament .303 Lewis machine gun

In 1925, British officer Major Gifford Martel designed a one-man tracked vehicle, which soon attracted official attention. When it was demonstrated that it was impossible for one man to both drive the tank and operate the machine gun, a two-man version (shown here) was developed. Used in the Experimental Mechanised Force, the Morris-Martel pioneered the tankette concept.

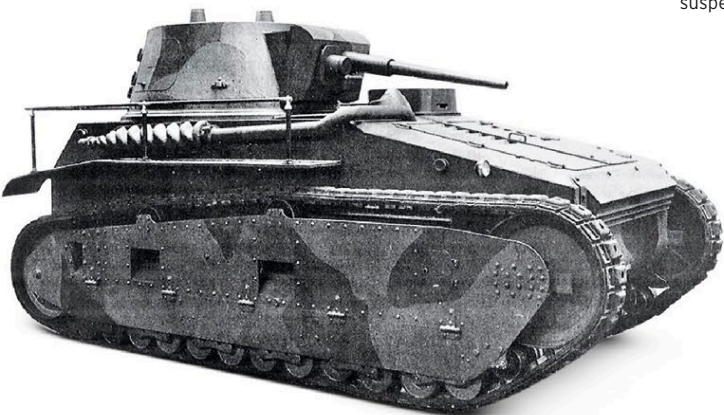


▷ **A1E1 Independent**
Date 1926 **Country** UK
Weight 35.8 tons (32.5 tonnes)
Engine Armstrong Siddeley V12 gasoline, 270 hp
Main armament QF 3-pounder gun

In addition to its main gun, the Independent had four machine guns in four separate turrets, plus a cupola for the commander of its eight-man crew. Only one was ever built, but its design was influential; the Soviet T-35 owes it a debt, as does the German Neubaufahrzeug series and possibly the British triple-turret Cruiser Mark I.



Side armor protects suspension



◁ **Leichttraktor Vs.Kfz.31**
Date 1930 **Country** Germany
Weight 10.6 tons (9.7 tonnes)
Engine Daimler-Benz gasoline, 100 hp
Main armament 3.7 cm KwK 36 L/45 gun

By secretly and illegally working with the Soviet Union at the Kama Tank School, Germany was able to build and operate a small number of tanks. Known as "tractors" for cover, they provided both soldiers and industry with experience of designing, building and operating tanks.



Wheels in raised position

37 mm Bofors m/38 gun